

dragged and dropped on forms.

ASP.NET applications are compiled. A compiler first takes in the entire program, checks for errors, compiles it and then executes it. PHP applications are interpreted. An interpreter does this line by line, so it takes one line, checks it for errors and then executes it. Nonetheless, PHP being a very simple language can afford to use an interpreter. And sometimes ASP.NET applications also tend to get slow as they access outside COM components. Despite all the theoretical facts going in favour of ASP.NET, in practice, PHP has been found to be faster and more efficient in handling load.



Fast Track to PHP in January 2009

If your customer has complicated web services needs, namespaces are a must. Implementing this feature in PHP can be an effort, especially for novices. For example if you've a function called 'add' in one module and another function with the same name in a different module within the same project, he will never be able to use them together if in PHP. These namespaces, however, are contained in ASP.NET.

There are many people who prefer PHP because it is directly connected to MySQL. Although MySQL is available on ASP.NET via ODBC connection, it requires to be configured by the system administrator and can be time consuming.

Debating their pros and cons can go on for ever, with killers and spoilers on either side. So the choice of implementation is totally yours! Let us consider some real life examples for better perception. Consider your client is a doctor with a small clinic and wants to have a simple website for contact details and a database of the patients to store their email addresses. You can recommend a typical PHP with MySQL configuration. The reason for this being, you can be up and running on WordPress in a matter of minutes. Besides, updating a WordPress site is as easy as composing an email. In fact, with a feature in WordPress, you can allow remote publishing whereby email to a secret email address is updated on the web site as a new post. Now it is up to you to charge him for support or give it for free and attract more customers.

MySQL is a relational database management system (RDBMS). It is most widely used. Apart from being open source and free, MySQL runs